Food Program Must Help Fewer Families in Gaza

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The World Food Programme, or WFP, is part of the **United Nations**. It gives food to people who need it. Now it says it does not have enough money to help as many people in Gaza.

The WFP will help about 1.1 million people instead of 1.6 million. That is about a third fewer. **Community kitchens** will serve 150,000 hot meals a day instead of 250,000. Some families in hard-to-reach places will get a meal every other day instead of every day.

A WFP leader, Shaun Hughes, said the **cuts** are about money. He said people still need the food.

Most of Gaza's 2.1 million people have had to leave their homes. Two out of three people depend on **food aid**. Stores have food, but most people have no jobs and cannot buy it.

Parents are worried. One mother of five asked how she will feed her little ones. The **cuts** come as winter gets close.

Word Treasure

United Nations -- The United Nations is a group of countries that work together to help people and keep peace.

community kitchens -- Community kitchens are places that cook and share meals with people who need food.

food aid -- Food aid is food given to people who cannot get enough on their own.

cuts -- Cuts are reductions, which means making something smaller or giving less of it.

Background you need

Gaza is a small Palestinian area by the sea where many families lost their homes after years of fighting.

The World Food Programme brings food to people in emergencies around the world.

It pays for that food with money that countries and others give, so when the money runs low, it can help fewer people.

Break it down

WHO: The World Food Programme, a United Nations group, and families in Gaza
WHAT: The WFP is cutting food help from about 1.6 million people to 1.1 million
WHERE: Gaza
WHY: The WFP does not have enough money, even though people still need the food

Why it matters

Just like kids everywhere, children in Gaza need enough food each day to stay healthy and learn.

Test what you remember

1. What does the World Food Programme do?

- (A) Builds roads
- (B) Gives food to people who need it
- (C) Runs hospitals only
- (D) Makes movies

2. Why is the WFP helping fewer people?

- (A) People do not need food anymore
- (B) It does not have enough money
- (C) The kitchens closed for a holiday
- (D) It is summer

3. How many people will the WFP help now?

- (A) About 2.1 million
- (B) About 250,000
- (C) About 1.1 million
- (D) About 1.6 million

4. How many hot meals will kitchens serve each day?

- (A) 250,000
- (B) 1 million
- (C) 10
- (D) 150,000

5. Why can't many people buy food in stores?

- (A) Most people have no jobs
- (B) Stores only open at night
- (C) Food is too heavy
- (D) Stores are empty

6. What season is coming soon?

- (A) Summer
- (B) Winter
- (C) Monsoon
- (D) Spring

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: B 3: C 4: D 5: A 6: B

Questions to think about

1. WFP leader Shaun Hughes: He says the cuts are about money, and people still need the food.

2. Parents in Gaza: They worry they will not have enough food for their children.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):